

Lessons from a quake: on the Myanmar earthquake

Rescue operations are **in full swing** following the **devastating** 7.7-magnitude **earthquake** centred in Myanmar, which, according to official estimates, **has claimed** more than 1,600 lives. With the death **toll** rising from the hundreds to over a thousand in just 24 hours, and information continuing to **trickle in**, a significantly higher casualty count cannot be **ruled out**. The number of injured stands at around 3,400. The **damage** to infrastructure **has** been massive, with large sections of **densely** populated cities such as Mandalay and Naypyitaw left without electricity. Hospitals are **overwhelmed**, and people are camping in the streets, their homes reduced to **rubble**. Myanmar's neighbours have responded swiftly, **dispatching** warships and aircraft loaded with relief materials and rescue personnel. **India, China, and Thailand** (**casualties** were reported after a **skyscraper** that was under construction in Bangkok **collapsed** despite being over 1,000 kilometres from the **epicentre**) **are** among the countries that have sent **aid**. Indian military aircraft made multiple **sorties** into Myanmar over the weekend, **ferrying** supplies and search-and-rescue **crews** to Naypyitaw, the capital, parts of which were **devastated** by the quake. Several Chinese rescue teams have also arrived, including one that crossed overland from Yunnan **province**, according to China's **embassy** in Myanmar.

Myanmar lies in a **seismically** active region at the **convergence** of four tectonic plates — the Eurasian, Indian, Sunda, and Burma microplate. The constant shifting and **collision** of these plates are responsible for most earthquakes in the region. **Quakes** of the magnitude **witnessed** on Friday **are** not uncommon; the Sagaing Fault, which is one of Myanmar's most active, has produced six to eight earthquakes of similar **intensity** since 1900, according to the United States Geological Survey. The Myanmar quake brings back memories of the 7.8 magnitude quake in Türkiye and Syria, in 2023, that killed at least 55,000. While accurately **predicting** the timing, location, and intensity of earthquakes remains beyond current scientific capability, probabilities can be estimated, and it is possible to strengthen **existing infrastructure** to **withstand seismic** events. Myanmar's **political instability** since the **coup** in 2021 **has** diverted attention from essential governance issues such as **enforcing** building codes. While the current damage is irreversible and recovery will take months, the existing **ceasefire** offers an opportunity to **push for** political **stability**. This can **foster** investment, attract expertise, and ensure better regulatory **enforcement** — critical **steps in** protecting the country against future disasters.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

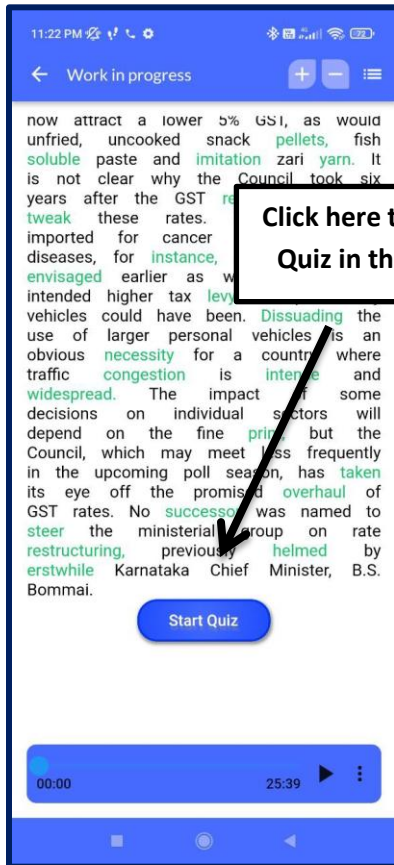
1. **Quake** (noun) – Earthquake, Tremor, Seismic activity, Shock, Temblor भूकंप
2. **In full swing** (phrase) – At peak activity, Underway, Ongoing, Progressing, Operational जोरों पर
3. **Following** (preposition) – After, Subsequent to, In the wake of, As a result of के बाद
4. **Devastating** (adjective) – Destructive, Catastrophic, Ruinous, Damaging, Harmful विनाशकारी
5. **Claim** (verb) – Take the lives लेना (ज़िंदगियाँ)
6. **Toll** (noun) – Cost, Price, Loss, Damage, Casualty count हानि
7. **Trickle in** (phrasal verb) – Arrive slowly, Come gradually, Filter in, Dribble in, Seep in धीरेधीरे आना
8. **Rule out** (phrasal verb) – Eliminate, Exclude, Discard, Reject, Dismiss खारिज करना
9. **Densely** (adverb) – Thickly, Heavily, Compactly, Crowdedly, Closely सघनता से
10. **Overwhelm** (verb) – Completely filled with something पूरी तरह से भरा हुआ
11. **Rubble** (noun) – Debris, Wreckage, Ruins, Fragments, Remains मलबा
12. **Dispatch** (verb) – Send, Forward, Transmit, Convey, Ship भेजना
13. **Casualty** (noun) – Victim, Fatality, Loss, Sufferer, Mortality हताहत
14. **Skyscraper** (noun) – High-rise, Tower block, Tall building, Edifice, Multi-story गगनचुंबी इमारत
15. **Collapse** (verb) – Fall down, Crumble, Cave in, Give way, Topple ढहना
16. **Epicentre** (noun) – Center, Focus, Core, Hotspot, Ground zero उपरिकेंद्र
17. **Aid** (noun) – Assistance, Help, Support, Relief, Succor सहायता
18. **Sorties** (noun) – a military operation
19. **Ferry** (verb) – Transport, Carry, Convey, Shuttle, Transfer ले जाना
20. **Crew** (noun) – Team, Squad, Unit, Personnel, Staff चालकदल
21. **Devastate** (verb) – Destroy, Ruin, Wreck, Ravage, Demolish तबाह करना
22. **Province** (noun) – Region, Territory, District, State, Area प्रांत
23. **Embassy** (noun) – Diplomatic mission, Consulate, Legation, Chancery दूतावास

24. **Seismically** (adverb) – Tectonically, Geologically, Earthquake-related भूकंपीय रूप से
25. **Convergence** (noun) – Meeting, Junction, Intersection, Merging, Confluence संगम
26. **Collision** (noun) – Crash, Impact, Clash, Smash, Wreck टक्कर
27. **Witness** (verb) – Observe, See, Experience, Behold, View देखना
28. **Intensity** (noun) – Strength, Power, Force, Severity, Magnitude तीव्रता
29. **Predict** (verb) – Forecast, Foresee, Anticipate, Project, Prophecy भविष्यवाणी करना
30. **Existing** (adjective) – Current, Present, Prevailing, Ongoing, Established मौजूदा
31. **Infrastructure** (noun) – Facilities, Framework, Structure, System, Foundation अवसंरचना
32. **Withstand** (verb) – Resist, Endure, Survive, Bear, Tolerate का सामना करना
33. **Seismic** (adjective) – Earthquake-related, Tectonic, Geological, Tremorous भूकंपीय
34. **Coup** (noun) – Takeover, Putsch, Overthrow, Rebellion, Uprising तख्तापलट
35. **Enforce** (verb) – Implement, Apply, Impose, Execute, Administer लागू करना
36. **Ceasefire** (noun) – Truce, Armistice, Peace agreement, Suspension of hostilities युद्धविराम
37. **Push for** (phrasal verb) – Advocate, Campaign, Lobby, Press, Urge दबाव डालना
38. **Stability** (noun) – Steadiness, Firmness, Solidity, Balance, Constancy स्थिरता
39. **Foster** (verb) – Encourage, Promote, Nurture, Cultivate, Support बढ़ावा देना
40. **Enforcement** (noun) – Implementation, Application, Execution, Administration प्रवर्तन
41. **Step in** (phrasal verb) – Intervene, Intercede, Interfere, Mediate, Act हस्तक्षेप करना

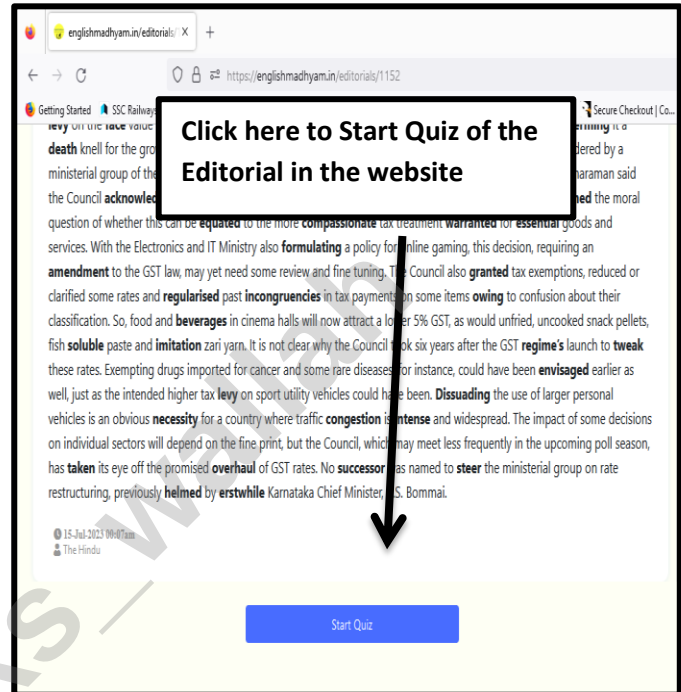
Summary of the Editorial

1. **Devastating Earthquake:** A 7.7-magnitude earthquake in Myanmar has caused widespread destruction, with over 1,600 deaths and 3,400 injured.
2. **Rising Casualties:** The death toll surged within 24 hours, and numbers may increase as more information comes in.
3. **Infrastructure Damage:** Major cities like Mandalay and Naypyitaw face power outages, collapsed buildings, and overwhelmed hospitals.
4. **Displaced Population:** Many residents are forced to camp on streets after their homes were destroyed.
5. **International Aid:** Neighboring countries, including India, China, and Thailand, have sent rescue teams, supplies, and military support.
6. **India's Assistance:** Indian aircraft conducted multiple relief missions, delivering aid and rescue personnel to Naypyitaw.
7. **China's Response:** Chinese teams arrived, including one that traveled overland from Yunnan province.
8. **Seismic Activity:** Myanmar lies at the convergence of four tectonic plates, making it prone to earthquakes.
9. **Historical Context:** The Sagaing Fault has produced 6-8 similar-magnitude quakes since 1900.
10. **Comparison to Türkiye-Syria Quake:** The disaster recalls the 2023 earthquake that killed 55,000, highlighting the region's vulnerability.
11. **Prediction Challenges:** Science cannot yet predict quakes accurately, but risk probabilities can be estimated.
12. **Need for Preparedness:** Strengthening infrastructure and enforcing building codes can mitigate future damage.
13. **Political Instability:** Myanmar's post-coup turmoil has hindered governance, including disaster preparedness.
14. **Ceasefire Opportunity:** The current truce could be leveraged to restore stability, attract investment, and improve regulations.
15. **Long-term Recovery:** Rebuilding will take months, but political stability is crucial for future disaster resilience.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



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